

Chapter 32-5

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The slapping scene with Chen Liuying afterward was supposed to be staged, but each time Chen Liuying couldn't deliver the effect the director wanted.

So after six NGs¹, Liang Shi didn't consult with Chen Liuying and directly slapped Chen Liuying across the face with a crisp sound, stunning Chen Liuying completely.

But Liang Shi immediately continued with her own performance. Her lines were fluent, her emotions full, each line delivered with indignation. After insulting her opponent, she even revealed a cold smile with a hint of malice that made people's hair stand on end.

After finishing the scene, the director praised, "Liang Shi, I never expected you to be such a good acting prospect."

Liang Shi modestly replied, "Not at all, it was just some improvisation."

"Now that's being modest," Zhao Ying said lightly from the side, but with a hint of stirring up trouble. "Your improvisation is already this good—what are those who've been acting for months but still got outperformed by you supposed to think? They'll cry."

Liang Shi: "..."

She glanced at Chen Liuying.

Chen Liuying covered the half of her face that had been slapped, "Liang Shi, you did that on purpose."

"To help you wrap up early," Liang Shi said calmly. "I did my best."

Chen Liuying: "..."

"Alright, it's all for the sake of the performance," the director mediated, taking the flowers handed over by the props team. "Congratulations Liuying, happy wrap!"

Chen Liuying was furious but couldn't make a scene.

After all, she still had to work in this industry.

However, on the car ride back to the hotel after finishing her scenes, she cursed in front of Bai Weiwei, "What kind of thing is that! Really thinks she can act now? Isn't it just because the character suits her? Young mistress being arrogant and domineering—she probably does this kind of thing all the time! Actually slapping me, so vicious."

"It didn't leave any marks," Bai Weiwei was a bit tired. "Consider it a sacrifice for art."

"But we agreed it would be staged," Chen Liuying said. "She just doesn't like us. That time you took Xu Qingzhu to Huayue International², she's been waiting to get revenge!"

"Chen Liuying!" Bai Weiwei scolded angrily. "We agreed not to bring that up."

Chen Liuying suddenly paused, shrinking into her seat with a cold laugh, "You treat her like a best friend, but does she treat you like one? What has she done besides encouraging you to break up? You really are a naive girl."

Bai Weiwei pressed her throbbing temples, "Zhu doesn't even know Liang Shi went out to act."

"So what if she knew? She'd probably be happy that her wife slapped your girlfriend," Chen Liuying said sarcastically. "Hasn't it been like this since school? She's always been better than you at everything. You think her wife is trash, but maybe she thinks you found yourself an actor."

"Zhu isn't that kind of person," Bai Weiwei said. "Stop talking."

"Heh, you never really know someone," Chen Liuying shrugged. "Anyway, think about it yourself—how come she gets Liang Shi to take the role while you get Zhao Xuning?"

"I said stop bringing this up," Bai Weiwei glared at her. "Are you done?"

"I'm just trying to remind you that no matter how trashy Liang Shi is, she's still Xu Qingzhu's wife. They're unified from beginning to end," Chen Liuying said. "Only a naive girl like you wouldn't protect your girlfriend. You let someone slap her and still think they're innocent."

Bai Weiwei turned her face away, not looking at her.

Footnotes:

¹ NG: "No Good" - film industry term for a take that needs to be redone

² Huayue International: A location mentioned earlier in the story, likely an entertainment venue